

Harbor Lantern Collective Strategic Plan 2026 Refresh

Adopted by the Board of Directors. Harbor Lantern Collective is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit founded in 2011.

Our Mission

Harbor Lantern Collective strengthens economic mobility for working families in Newark's East Ward through adult education, workforce training and small-business coaching.

Our Vision

A neighborhood where every resident can turn hard work into lasting financial stability.

Our Values

- We start from the strengths residents already have.
- We teach in the languages our neighbors speak.
- We measure what matters and share what we learn.

Who We Serve

Populations Served

We serve adults aged 18 to 64 with household incomes below 200 percent of the federal poverty level, with a focus on recent immigrants, returning citizens and single parents.

Geographic Scope

Our service area is Newark's East Ward and the Ironbound neighborhood in Essex County, New Jersey.

Community Context

Residents of our service area speak Spanish and Portuguese at home at more than twice the citywide rate, and many hold jobs with irregular hours. Our programs are scheduled in the evening and on weekends for that reason.

Strategic Priorities 2026-2028

The Board adopted four strategic priorities for this period.

- Priority 1. Expand bilingual workforce training to 500 learners a year by 2028.
- Priority 2. Launch a digital skills lab with 40 workstations by 2027.
- Priority 3. Build data and evaluation capacity, including a participant outcomes database.
- Priority 4. Diversify revenue so that no single funder provides more than 30 percent of annual income.

How We Will Know

Each priority has an owner on the leadership team and is reviewed by the Board every quarter.

Resourcing the Plan

Funding Goals

Raise \$1.5 million in new multi-year grants between 2026 and 2028, including at least \$450,000 for the digital skills lab.

Partnerships

We work with the Eastside Employers Roundtable to match graduates with openings, and with Lantern Street Credit Union on savings accounts for participants.

Sample document for product testing. The organization, funder and figures are fictional.